

Messianic Prophecy Fulfilled!—“He Will Not Quarrel”

2026 Regional Convention — Talk No. 4

Manuscript draft | Assigned time: 17 minutes | Two videos

Green = main idea · Orange = contrast · Blue = application or delivery action

WHAT WAS PROPHESED? (3 min.)

(Warm, expectant)

In the first part of this symposium, we began following prophecies that identify the Messiah. Now we will consider a quality that is easy to overlook because it is quiet. The Messiah would establish justice—but he would not do it by making himself the centre of attention.

Let us watch another excerpt from Episode 4 of *The Good News According to Jesus*. As you watch, look for the kind of authority Jesus had—and the way he chose to use it.

VIDEO 1 — Play 02-CO-v26_E_041 (outline: 0:46; file runtime: 0:50)

What did we see? Even unclean spirits recognised Jesus and fell before him. Yet he sternly ordered them not to make him known. That was not weakness. It was power under perfect control.

Centuries earlier, Isaiah described both the Messiah’s authority and his manner. Please notice the balance in the prophecy.

Read Isaiah 42:1-4.

Jehovah’s chosen servant would bring justice to the nations. Still, he would not shout in the street, crush a damaged reed, or extinguish a weak flame. True justice in the Messiah’s hands would be faithful, quiet, and compassionate. How was every part of that prophecy fulfilled?

HOW WAS THE PROPHECY FULFILLED? (8 min.)

The religious leaders of Jesus' day spoke often about justice. But their rule-making could leave suffering people feeling judged rather than helped. By contrast, Matthew 12:15-18 connects Isaiah's prophecy with Jesus. His words and actions showed what true justice looks like. It was never cold or merely legal.

Where legalism saw a case, Jesus saw a person. He was compassionate and merciful toward people who were poor, ill, or discouraged.

Did you notice how often justice appears in those four verses? The servant would "bring justice," he would do so "in faithfulness," and he would continue until justice was established. So his gentle manner would never mean indifference to right and wrong. He would be immovable about Jehovah's standards while being approachable to people who wanted help. That combination—firm principles and tender treatment—identified Jesus.

For example, when the leaders criticised Jesus for healing on the Sabbath, they concentrated on their own interpretation of a rule. Jesus concentrated on Jehovah's loving purpose and on the suffering person in front of him. He did not lower Jehovah's standard. He revealed the justice behind it. A just decision in Jehovah's eyes makes room for mercy, because Jehovah himself is merciful.

Isaiah also said that the Messiah would not quarrel or make his voice heard in the main streets. Jesus did teach publicly, but Matthew 12:19 shows that he did not promote himself noisily or create a sensation around his own name. He was not building a personal following apart from Jehovah. Even after performing remarkable cures, he often told people not to advertise what he had done.

The next excerpt shows one example. Watch what Jesus told a man whom he had just healed—and what happened when that instruction was not followed.

VIDEO 2 — Play 04-CO-v26_E_042 (outline: 0:52; file runtime: 0:56)

Jesus told the man: "See that you say nothing to anyone," and then directed him to follow the arrangement in the Law. The man was understandably thrilled, but his widespread publicity had a practical result: Jesus could no longer enter a city openly. He had to remain outside in isolated places. Jesus did not need or seek that kind of attention.

Consider another occasion. At the pool of Bethzatha, Jesus healed a man who had been ill for 38 years. John 5:2-13 says that the man did not even know who

had healed him, because Jesus had slipped away into the crowd. Jesus did not wait for applause or make the man's relief into a platform for himself.

Imagine the temptation an imperfect person might feel after such a cure: stay close, collect the praise, perhaps retell the event until everyone knows who deserves the credit. Jesus simply helped the man and moved on. The relief of that suffering person mattered more to him than public recognition.

And what about the demons in the first video? The study note on Mark 3:11, 12 explains why Jesus refused their testimony. They were rebels and enemies of Jehovah. The truth about the Messiah would not be established by the publicity of wicked spirits. Jesus trusted Jehovah's way and Jehovah's time for making his identity clear.

So Jesus fulfilled the words, "He will not quarrel, nor cry aloud." But notice that his quietness was not detachment. Isaiah said: "No crushed reed will he break, and no smoldering wick will he extinguish." A bruised reed bends easily. A smoldering wick gives very little light. In a similar way, some people Jesus met had been bent by hardship or had almost lost hope. Matthew 12:20, 21 applies those words to him. He gave special attention to the lowly and discouraged. **He did not treat fragile people as disposable.** He comforted them and gave them a solid reason to hope in his name.

Think of the beautiful balance: Jesus would not amplify his own name, yet he would not overlook the quiet pain of someone else. He was firm for what was right, but never harsh with those who needed help. He brought justice without quarrelling, hope without spectacle, and strength without crushing the weak. That is the Messiah Isaiah promised—and exactly the Messiah Jesus proved to be.

This also explains why people who had been made to feel unworthy were drawn to Jesus. In his presence, they did not have to compete with louder voices to be noticed. He could see the small remaining flame. Instead of asking, "How much strength does this person have left?" he showed, in effect, "How can I help that strength grow?"

WHAT CAN WE LEARN FROM THE MESSIAH? (6 min.)

First, **direct attention to Jehovah and the Kingdom, not to ourselves.** Jesus performed miracles and taught with unmatched wisdom, yet he did not behave like the hypocritical religious leaders described at Matthew 6:2, 5, who wanted

to be noticed. He allowed sincere people to reach the right conclusion from what they saw and heard. And when he healed a paralysed man, Matthew 9:2-8 says that the crowd glorified God. The attention went where Jesus wanted it to go—to his Father.

We imitate him when we make the Bible, not our personality, the source of the truths we teach. At John 7:16-18, Jesus explained that his teaching came from the One who sent him. In the ministry, then, our goal is not to impress someone with a clever answer. It is to help that person see solid evidence in God's Word and draw a sound conclusion. If a listener remembers our illustration but forgets the scripture, the spotlight may have landed in the wrong place.

That affects even simple choices: how much we speak, whether we really listen to the reply, and what we do when a person praises us. We can warmly redirect appreciation to the practical wisdom of the Bible or to Jehovah's loving interest. We do not need to force a conclusion or make ourselves the authority. We open the evidence, ask a question, and give the person room to think.

Second, **reason with people; do not quarrel.** The study note on 2 Timothy 2:24 shows that a servant of the Lord must not become involved in verbal fights or contentious debates. A conversation is not a contest with a scorecard—although our imperfect heart may occasionally reach for an imaginary one. If someone challenges us, we do not have to win the exchange. Like Jesus, we can remain mild, ask a thoughtful question, and let Bible evidence do its work.

Suppose the person makes a sharp statement or repeats an objection we have heard many times. Our tone may answer before our words do. A defensive voice can turn a discussion into a quarrel even if every sentence is technically correct. A calm question—"May I ask what led you to feel that way?"—can uncover a concern we would otherwise miss. Peaceful reasoning is not retreat. It shows confidence that truth does not need an angry defender.

Third, **be kind, patient, and genuinely interested in the person.** Mark 1:41 says that Jesus was moved with pity before he helped the man with leprosy. He did not merely have the correct answer; he cared. Lesson 3 of *Love People—Make Disciples* reminds us that people are more likely to listen when they sense that we care about them. So listen. Try to understand what is behind their words. Speak kindly. Where appropriate, offer practical help.

Some we meet may resemble Isaiah's bruised reed. Life has bent them. Others may be like a smouldering wick: there is still a spark of interest, but it is weak.

Pressure, impatience, or an argument could extinguish that spark. Kindness may give it air. When people sense sincere care, they are more likely to speak about their spiritual need—the need Jesus highlighted at Matthew 5:3. And helping them is not only good for them; it brings us real happiness too.

We may not know what happened before we knocked on the door or began the conversation. The person may be grieving, exhausted, or disappointed by religion. That does not mean we avoid the good news; it means we offer it in Jesus' manner. Perhaps the most helpful thing in that visit is one reassuring scripture, one sincere question, and the promise to return. Patient care gives truth time to take root.

So remember the Messiah's pattern: give Jehovah the attention, give people the evidence, and give the discouraged tender care. Jesus never had to quarrel to prove who he was. His faithful conduct, compassionate justice, and quiet humility fulfilled the prophecy.

(Warm handoff; turn toward next speaker)

Brother _____ will now present the final part of this symposium, entitled “Without an Illustration He Would Not Speak.”